

Figure 4: Resource roles for the project

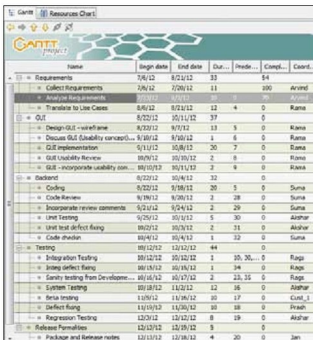


Figure 5: Tasks pane with details

chart to the beginning of the project, and *Today* will bring it to the current week. *Selection* will move the focus of the chart to the task selected in the left pane.

Project set-up

The first step in creating a new project is to update *Properties* in the *Project* menu. Here, you enter project details such as name, organisation and URL. You can then select the *Calendar* option to select a suitable holiday calendar, and working days that are applicable to all resources in the project. Unfortunately, there is no calendar for Indian holidays packaged with the tool. *Resources* allows you to create new resource roles. Later, in *Resources Chart*, the role appears as a drop-down for each resource added.

You can add resources to the project via the *Resources Chart*

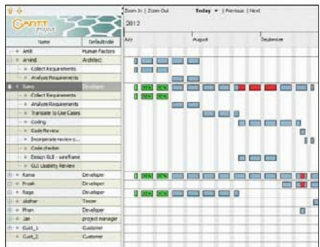


Figure 6: Resources chart tab

tab in the left pane. You can add new resources, and their roles, by selecting *New Resource* from the *Resources* menu.

Adding tasks

A project is a set of tasks performed by resources. Tasks have a duration, with dependencies between them. When using a PM tool such as GanttProject, always remember to use the tool's capability to schedule the task, instead of entering the start and end dates. The ideal way to enter tasks is to enter the task name and its duration, and link to its predecessor or successor. The start and end dates are computed by the tool based on dependent tasks, their duration, resource availability during that time, and company working days.

Adding resources

Resources are added into the *Resource Chart* pane with additional details like the default role. After assigning resources to tasks, you get a list of tasks and work loads for each resource in the *Resource Chart*. This helps the manager assess the duration when a resource is overloaded, and to perform an operation called 'resource levelling'. This operation is available in MS Project but not in GanttProject.

You can see in the example in Figure 6 that two developers have more than 100 per cent load in August and September. In the *Resources Chart* tab, on the left are the resource names and roles; the right pane shows their load each week.

Features in GanttProject

We can classify the features of GanttProject as input, process and output. Input is the various formats that GanttProject can accept. Process features are the real value-additions the tool provides, such as charts, dependencies and computation to create schedules. The output comprises the formats in which we can export the project schedule.

The tool accepts MS Project format and text files, other than its own .gan format. The .gan file is in XML